That I should be asked to go into Conference at Paris while a subordinate branch of the British Government 6,000 miles away dictates to the British Government what line it thinks I ought to pursue in Thrace seems to me quite intolerable...For if the Government of India, because it rules over a large body of Moslems, is entitled to express and publish its views about what we do in Smyrna or Thrace, why not equally in Egypt, the Soudan, Palestine, Arabia, the Malay Peninsula or any other part of the Moslem world. Is Indian opinion always to be a final court of Moslem appeal[?][86]

Not only does this give an insight into Curzon's thoughts on the Indian government's input on foreign policy but, again, it goes some way to explaining why Delhi was ignored in these post-war years. In the foreign secretary's view Reading's opinion was both unwelcome and inappropriate. And unfortunately for the viceroy it was not only Curzon who thought so. Hardinge too argued that 'If India is to dictate our policy in Europe the F.O. had better shut up shop.'[87] Apparently being ex-viceroys did not equal greater sympathy from Curzon and Hardinge towards the Indian government. It has already been shown how Curzon had himself lamented being ignored by the Home government when he was out in India. How short his memory appeared to be.

The fact that both Curzon and Hardinge used the term 'dictate' is also interesting – the Indian government was actually 'dictating' very little when it came to British foreign policy in the years after 1918. Likewise the remarks by Curzon are indicative of a failing on his part to grasp the importance of the pan-Islamic issue in the post-war period. One contemporary 'likened the Islamic world to a gigantic drum, the reverberations from one end of which could be heard at the other'.[88] The idea that peace with Turkey was a European issue and therefore did not concern the Indian government demonstrates how short-sighted the Foreign Office was. Ultimately the Foreign Office failed to grasp the connections between the various problems facing the British Empire in this period. It refused to see the links between its treatment of Turkey and of Muslim agitation in India, and ignored the Indian government when such warnings were given.[89] The international nature of the Caliphate movement and of